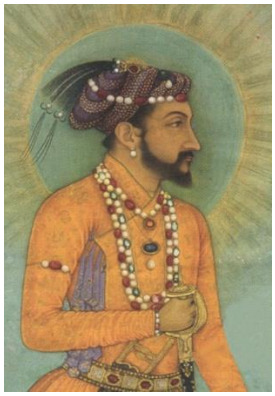
Taj Mahal – A Monument of Eternal Love & Architectural Glory

Introduction

The **Taj Mahal** is one of the most iconic monuments in the world, located in **Agra, Uttar Pradesh, India**. It was commissioned by the Mughal emperor *Shah Jahan* in memory of his beloved wife *Mumtaz Mahal* after she died in 1631 during childbirth. Construction began around 1632 and continued for over two decades, involving more than 20,000 artisans and craftsmen from across India and abroad. Today, the Taj Mahal is a UNESCO World Heritage Site admired for its beauty and harmony. Encyclopedia Britannica

The architecture of the Taj Mahal blends elements from Persian, Ottoman, Indian, and Islamic styles. Its central mausoleum stands on a raised platform of white marble, with a magnificent dome and symmetrical minarets flanking it. Intricate inlays, calligraphy, and reflective pools enhance its aesthetic appeal, making it a symbol of both artistic achievement and emotional depth. Encyclopedia Britannica

Portrait of Shah Jahan



The monument not only commemorates the love between Shah Jahan and Mumtaz Mahal, but also reflects the zenith of Mughal architectural innovation. Its design incorporates careful symmetry, complex craftsmanship, and a garden layout inspired by the Islamic concept of paradise. Encyclopedia Britannica

Mughal emperor Shah Jahan, born in 1592, was the fifth ruler of the Mughal dynasty and reigned from 1628 to 1658. He is best known for his architectural contributions, including the Taj Mahal, which he built as a mausoleum for his favorite wife, Mumtaz Mahal. Under his leadership, Mughal art and culture reached a remarkable peak.